St Ignatius' College
Riverview

2024

HIGHER
SCHOOL
CERTIFICATE

Task 1

Business Studies

General Instructions

- Working time – 55 minutes
- Write using black pen
- Calculators approved by NESA may be used

Total marks: 40

Section I – 10 marks

- Attempt Questions 1–10
- Allow 10 about 15 minutes for this section

Section II – 30 marks

- Attempt Questions 11–13
- Allow about 40 minutes for this section

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Section I

10 marks
Attempt Questions 1–10
Allow about 15 minutes for this section

Use the multiple-choice answer sheet for Questions 1–10.

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1 Mi-Fone sells touch screen mobile phone devices and offers customers a free "how to" lesson.

Which of the following best describes the products sold?

	Good	*Service*
(A)	Mobile Phone	Mobile Phone
(B)	Mobile Phone	How to lesson
(C)	How to lesson	Mobile Phone
(D)	How to lesson	How to lesson

2 A fast-food chain invests in new technology to increase speed and output.

Which of the following best describes the strategic role of operations for this business?

(A) Unique Selling Point
(B) Economies of Scale
(C) Cost Leadership
(D) Differentiation

3 Which of the following best describes the interdependence between operations and human resources.

(A) Task design and securing relevant personnel
(B) Task design and the promotion of new products
(C) Product layout and the securing of funds for a new factory
(D) Product layout and the scheduling of each task

4 Robert is an accountant who provides financial services to customers.

Which of the following is NOT a transforming resource for this business?

(A) Computer software
(B) Office desks
(C) The Accountant
(D) Financial information

5 Safe working environment and safe working practices are examples of responses to which influence?

(A) Government
(B) Quality expectations
(C) Legal regulation
(D) Globalisation

6 In response to a health pandemic a beer producer has switched production to manufacturing hand sanitiser.
Which performance objective does this illustrate?

(A) Cost
(B) Flexibility
(C) Quality
(D) Speed

7 A manager at a frozen food manufacturer wants to change the operations process in response to the influence of corporate social responsibility.

Which action would achieve this objective?

(A) Ensuring that injured workers receive access to workers compensation
(B) Increasing the visibility of the manufacturing process
(C) Offering a wider variety of healthier products
(D) Providing cash donations to a local children's hospital

8 Process layout refers to

(A) Assembly lines, robotics and CAM
(B) The organisation of activities according to function
(C) The setting out of equipment in the same sequence as the operations process
(D) The arrangement of all the machinery around the product assembly

9 A computer manufacturing company examines global trends in computer technology.

This is an example of which of the following?

(A) Global sourcing
(B) Research and development
(C) Inventory management
(D) Scanning and learning

10 Which of the following activities are involved in monitoring, control and improvement?

(A) Comparing actual and planned data, making adjustments to processes, total quality management
(B) Increasing production output, total quality management, inertia
(C) Designing new products, comparing actual and planned data, scanning and learning
(D) Scanning and learning, comparing products with competitors, making adjustments to processes

End of Section I

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Student Number

Business Studies
Section II

30 marks
Attempt Questions 11–13
Allow about 40 minutes for this section

Instructions

- Write your Centre Number and Student Number at the top of this page.
- Answer the questions in the spaces provided. These spaces provide guidance for the expected length of response.
- If you utilise a writing booklet for additional space, please ensure that it is clearly labelled

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2024 HSC

Business Studies

Student Number

Section II

Question 11 (10 marks)

EVO manufactures batteries and supplies these to electric vehicle producers internationally. Recently EVO has gained a reputation for late deliveries.

(a) Outline the influence technology has on the operations of this business. **2**

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(b) Explain the importance of sequencing and scheduling for this business. **4**

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c) EVO will increase their product warranty from 1 to 5 years.

How do increased warranties impact the operations process? **4**

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End of Question 11
Please turn over

Question 12 (10 marks)

Chris Cringle Decorations are a large Sydney based seller of artificial Christmas trees and decorations. They currently source stock from a Chinese manufacturer and storage cost have doubled within the last 6 months.

(a) Outline an impact of globalisation on this business. **2**

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(b) Recommend a suitable Inventory Management Strategy for this business. **3**

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(c) Analyse the impact of variation in demand and variety on this business. **5**

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End of Question 12

Please turn over

Question 13 (10 marks)

Jiminy's Cricket Company (JCC) manufactures high quality cricket gear. In order to improve profitability materials will now be sourced from the global market.

(a) Discuss the balance between cost and quality for this business. **3**

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(b) JCC are considering outsourcing the production of cricket balls.

Describe how outsourcing could help this business sustain its competitive advantage. **3**

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(c) JCC have purchased leading-edge technology to help achieve economies of scale.

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Explain why both staff and management might be resistant to change.

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End of Question 13

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